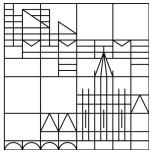
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Appendix: About Practice Final Projects

Registering for exams

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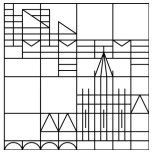
- **Exam registration period: 01.12.2025 - 15.01.2026**
  (deregistration possible until 31.01.2026)
- You need to **register separately** for ICSS (Theory) and ICSS (Practice)
- You also have to register for the Python Block Course to get the credits!

- **Each year, you have one chance for ICSS (Practice)**
  - The standard number of tries is two (thus two years)

- In ICSS (Theory) you will have to register for the resit if you need to take it
  - 2nd exam period: check university website
- Note for ICSS (Theory): if you pass the first try, you cannot go to the resit to improve your grade

Grading of ICSS (Practice)

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ICSS (Theory) and ICSS (Practice) are graded separately and it is possible to pass one and not the other.

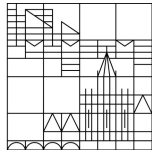
You do not need to pass both parts the same year but we strongly recommend that you focus on passing both in the first semester

Grading parts of ICSS (Practice):

- **Mandatory assignments:** To be allowed to submit a final project, you need to pass each of the four assignments
- **Final practical project.** The grade final grade of ICSS (Practice) is the grade of the final project.

ICSS (Practice) final projects

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General aim of the final projects: Individual students showcase their practical learning through a programming project of their own choice.

The first aim is to **build** something – the final product is the software, not the report. You will write papers in other courses.

The second aim is to **learn by doing**. You should go out of what is covered in the practical part and learn something new on your own. For example an API, a new library, another algorithm, a method…

The third aim is to develop the skill of **planning a project.** This is an iterative project, not a final exam. There will be plenty of chances to get feedback from lecturers and tutors, do discuss your ideas, feasibility, resources, etc.

Final project code

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- Will be audited as part of the grading process
- Grading criteria
  - **Code readability:** variable names, structure, good programming practices…
  - **Code organization:** separation of project into files that structure the code and tasks
  - **No redundancy,** unnecessary functions or repeated code
  - **Meaningful comments** and justification/explanations
  - **Code execution**
    - Your code will be locally executed and inspected for bugs or unstable behavior
    - You have to include documentation on how to run it, dependencies, etc
    - Target: a fellow student can install and run with 10 minutes of work

Final project report

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- Written report to complement code
- It should cover the following:
  - Brief **motivation** of the project: why should this be built?
  - Outline of **design** approach: structure, tasks, parts of the project
  - **Detail on new** algorithms, software, etc. Focus on what you learned and why it matters for the project
  - **Demo, results, or outcomes of the project**
  - Report on challenges, issues, further ideas
  - Not a research paper but it has to give context, motivation, and interpretation of the result/product of the project

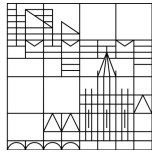
Final project video

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- Short video where you answer a few questions and show your code
- **Designed not to invest a lot of time on production**
- Think about it as an asynchronous interview
- Offers a channel for you to **show insights** that are not captured well in code, comments, or the report
- Instructions on what to show and questions will be released soon
- **Questions are designed to show critical understanding of the project, if you abuse AI, it will be clear in the video**
- **Video has only pass/fail grade**
    - **Final grade is composed of code and report, weighting of each part depends on project task and aims**

Honor code and authorship statement

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- A project **has to be your own**, nobody else should write a single line of code, report text, or content for the video
- You are **not allowed to copy code** from online or offline resources for the project, including AI coding assistants
- You will have to submit an authorship statement with your final project and abuse of AI coding assistants can lead to plagiarism investigations
- If you abuse AI or help from others, this will be visible in the quality of your code and of your video explanation

Final project submission

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A final project submission is composed of:

1. project code
2. report
3. short video explanation
4. signed authorship statement

The deadline for the final project submission is 22.03, 23:59

- Submission will be over github similarly as assignments
- If the video is too heavy as a file, it can be linked to the uni cloud

Timing: the last assignment deadline is 25.01. You have two months for exams and project work. Don't underestimate the project, calculate a total of 90 hours of work on the project along the whole semester.

Random project ideas

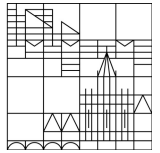
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Some (barely tested) examples of what you could do:

- A recommender website to choose where to live based on your interests and Facebook advertising data
  - Data collected with pysocialwatcher
  - Interactive website that collects user input and matches it to cities
- AWESOME-O: A program that generates movie arguments from a starting sentence and data from the Internet Movie DataBase
  - Training a simple language model with IMDB text
  - Program chatbot and experiment distinguishing real from fake
- Data collection and visualization of the Bluesky accounts of politicians of a country
  - Scraping a list of accounts from official sites
  - Using the Bluesky API
  - Network visualization and analysis

Random project ideas

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Substantially extending an assignment:

- Training a model that identifies from a script whether the movie pases or not the Bechdel test
- Measuring polarization with Eurovision data and correlating that with interest rates of sovereign bonds
- Visualizing the correlation between voting results for US presidential candidates and Google trends across US states

Start thinking, talking, and asking questions soon!
Do use the forum for random shower ideas, get our input soon and often!